discomfited and beaten, he fled to Samarkand. Peace was again brought between the Sulṭān Mahmud Khān and Sulṭān Ahmed Mīrzā.[*]

The latter handed over Tashkent to his younger brother, Babur's father, Umar Shaikh Mīrzā. From then onwards, Umar retained the Tashkent.

Umar's Children

Babur was the eldest among the three brothers and seven daughters. He was born from Qutluq-Nigar Khānum. Babur in his memoir does mention that only eight grew up, and hence perhaps some died at birth. Jahangir Mīrzā was Umar's second son with Fatima Sulṭān Agha. He was born two years after Babur's birth. Fatima Sulṭān was the daughter of one of the begs of Mogul Tumen.[7] [8] Nasir Mīrzā, four years younger than Babur and the third son of Umar Shaikh Mīrzā, was born to Umid Aghacha. She was from Andijān.

Khānzada Begum was the eldest daughter of Umar born to Qutluq-Nigar Khānim. She was Babur's sibling and was five years older than him. Babur has mentioned the agony relating to Khānzada. He had to abandon Samarkand for the second time in AD 1500 after a five-month siege by Aūzbeg lord Shaybāni Khān. He had tried his best to win the war, but no help or reinforcement had come from any beg. The period Babur describes as one of the most despairing and helpless ones although the records find that his worst days were yet to come. Khānzada had only one boy child with Shaybāni Khān. Babur saw him as a pleasant child and he was named Khurram Shah. When Khurram grew a bit, he was given the Balkh. However, he died soon. In that period, Khānzada Begum was in Merv. Shah Ismail had ravished Shaybāni Khān's land in the Battle of Merv and it was a gigantic loss to the Aūzbegs. Shah Ismail showed enough decency to not misbehave with Babur's sister. She was respectfully escorted back to Kunduz.

It was a moment of relief and ecstasy for both Babur and her. Babur met her after ten years and the expressions in his memoir truly reflect the deep emotion they shared. He had gone to meet her with Muhammadi Kukuldash (we don't have many details about this person). Interestingly, Babur writes that neither Khānzada nor people around her could recognize him and it took a bit of time to recall the familiarity.

The other daughters born to Umar were:

- Mihr Banu Begum was the second daughter of Umar Shaikh Mīrzā. She was a sibling to Nasir Mīrzā and two years younger